

CDC Flexi 03 – 2026

VARC Section — 24 Questions

Directions for Questions 1 to 4: The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

The world will be transformed. By 2050, we will be driving electric cars and flying in aircraft running on synthetic fuels produced through solar and wind energy. New energy-efficient technologies, most likely harnessing artificial intelligence, will dominate nearly all human activities from farming to heavy industry. Perhaps our planet will even be orbited by massive solar arrays capturing cosmic energy from sunlight and generating seemingly endless energy for all our needs.

That is one possible future for humanity. It's an optimistic view of how radical changes to energy production might help us slow or avoid the worst outcomes of global warming. In a report from 1965, scientists from the US government warned that our ongoing use of fossil fuels would cause global warming with potentially disastrous consequences for Earth's climate. 'Through his worldwide industrial civilisation,' the report concluded, 'Man is unwittingly conducting a vast geophysical experiment' – an experiment with a highly uncertain outcome, but clear and important risks for life on Earth.

Since then, we've dithered and doubted and argued about what to do, but still have not managed to take serious action to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, which continue to rise. Governments around the planet have promised to phase out emissions in the coming decades and transition to 'green energy'. But global temperatures may be rising faster than we expected: some climate scientists worry that rapid rises could create new problems and positive feedback loops that may accelerate climate destabilisation and make parts of the world uninhabitable long before a hoped-for transition is possible.

Despite this bleak vision of the future, there are reasons for optimists to hope due to progress on cleaner sources of renewable energy, especially solar power. Around 2010, solar energy generation accounted for less than 1 per cent of the electricity generated by humanity. But experts believe that, by 2027, due to falling costs, better technology and exponential growth in new installations, solar power will become the largest global energy source for producing electricity. If progress on renewables continues, we might find a way to resolve the warming problem linked to greenhouse gas emissions. By 2050, large-scale societal and ecological changes might have helped us avoid the worst consequences of our extensive use of fossil fuels.

It's a momentous challenge. And it won't be easy. But this story of transformation only hints at the true depth of the future problems humanity will confront in managing our energy use and its influence over our climate.

As scientists are gradually learning, even if we solve the immediate warming problem linked to the greenhouse effect, there's another warming problem steadily growing beneath it. Let's call it the 'deep warming' problem. This deeper problem also raises Earth's surface temperature but, unlike global warming, it has nothing to do with greenhouse gases and our use of fossil fuels. It stems directly from our use of energy in all forms and our tendency to use more energy over time – a problem created by the inevitable waste heat that is generated whenever we use energy to do something. Yes, the world may well be transformed by 2050. Carbon dioxide levels may stabilise or fall thanks to advanced AI-assisted technologies that run on energy harvested from the sun and wind. And the fossil fuel industry may be

taking its last breaths. But we will still face a deeper problem. That's because 'deep warming' is not created by the release of greenhouse gases into the atmosphere. It's a problem built into our relationship with energy itself.

Question 1

According to the passage, which of the following scenarios would MOST likely exacerbate the *deep warming* problem?

- 1) A global shift to renewable energy systems that replaces fossil fuels while keeping total energy demand broadly unchanged.
- 2) A gradual transition to cleaner energy sources accompanied by sustained reductions in per-capita energy consumption worldwide.
- 3) Coordinated international policies that prioritise energy efficiency while maintaining existing levels of industrial production.
- 4) The rapid spread of advanced technologies that substantially increase overall energy use even as carbon emissions are eliminated.

Question 2

Given the arguments presented in the passage, which of the following best describes the relationship between *energy transformation* and *future climate challenges*?

- 1) Technological change in energy systems is sufficient to permanently eliminate all forms of climate-related warming.
- 2) Progress in clean energy may reduce one type of warming while allowing other systemic problems to persist.
- 3) Large-scale adoption of renewable energy ensures long-term climatic stability without introducing new environmental risks.
- 4) Phasing out fossil fuels will eventually reverse all human-induced temperature increases across the planet.

Question 3

Which of the following statements, if false, would most seriously weaken the passage's concern regarding *deep warming*?

- 1) Every use of energy necessarily produces some quantity of waste heat as an unavoidable physical consequence.
- 2) Increases in global temperature can be fully explained by the accumulation of greenhouse gases alone.
- 3) Human societies have generally exhibited a long-term tendency toward rising aggregate energy consumption.
- 4) Future economic systems are likely to remain dependent on energy-intensive technological infrastructures.

Question 4

According to the passage, what is the primary reason the *deep warming* problem would continue even if greenhouse gas emissions decline?

- 1) Renewable energy technologies remain less efficient than fossil-fuel-based systems at large operational scales.
- 2) Climatic feedback mechanisms may persistently amplify temperature changes despite reductions in emissions.
- 3) Waste heat generated by energy use accumulates regardless of whether the energy source is clean or dirty.
- 4) Delays in political decision-making slow the implementation of effective climate mitigation strategies.

Question 5

There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide where (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: Drawing on years of scientific data, I've been arguing for some time that this risk exists – and that governments are completely unprepared for it.

Paragraph: The fate of environmentalists is to spend their lives trying not to be proved right. Vindication is what we dread. ____1____. But there's one threat that haunts me more than any other: the collapse of the global food system. ____2____. We cannot predict what the immediate trigger might be. But the war with Iran is just the right kind of event. ____3____. In 2023, I made a submission to a parliamentary inquiry into environmental change and food security, with a vast list of references. ____4____. Called as a witness, I spent much of the time explaining that the issue was much wider than the inquiry's scope.

- 1) Option 1
- 2) Option 2
- 3) Option 3
- 4) Option 4

Question 6

There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide where (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: Homes are where we take refuge from the outside world, express ourselves, build relationships and families.

Paragraph: Housing is as personal an issue as it gets. ____1____. To buy or rent a house is to project your aspirations and dreams on to bricks and mortar – can we see ourselves sitting outside in the sunshine on that patio? It can also be a deeply frustrating process – can we afford that house? For more and more of us, the answer is no. ____2____. Experienced at such an individual level, it's easy to think that rising costs are a problem particular to your community, city or country. But unaffordable house prices and rents are a continent-wide issue. ____3____. According to the European Parliament, from 2015 to 2023, in absolute terms, house prices in the EU rose by just under 50% on average. From 2010 to 2022, rents rose by 18%. ____4____.

- 1) Option 1
- 2) Option 2
- 3) Option 3
- 4) Option 4

Question 7

The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

Engraved on three stone slabs at Canterbury Cathedral is a list of all the archbishops of Canterbury, beginning with St. Augustine in A.D. 597. The first 105 names belong to men. The newest name, though, inscribed by a stonemason two months ago, breaks the mold: Sarah Elisabeth Mullally. On Wednesday, Archbishop Mullally, 63, was formally installed as the most senior cleric in the Church of England and

spiritual leader of the Anglican Communion, which includes some 85 million Anglicans around the world. The ceremony, rich with tradition and attended by the British prime minister and the prince and princess of Wales, was weighted with significance for many in the church. "Installing Sarah as our first female archbishop would have almost been unimaginable even 50 years ago," said the Very Rev. Dr. David Monteith, dean of Canterbury Cathedral, speaking ahead of the ceremony. "Today matters." While she legally took up the role in January, Archbishop Mullally's installation on Wednesday was the symbolic start of her ministry, where she delivered her inaugural sermon to around 2,000 people.

- 1) The installation of Sarah Mullally as the first female Archbishop of Canterbury marks a historic break from tradition and reflects significant progress within the Church of England.
- 2) The appointment of Sarah Mullally highlights the evolving traditions of the Church of England, as her formal installation signals a broader shift toward inclusivity and institutional change.
- 3) The ceremonial installation of Sarah Mullally underscores both continuity and change in the Church of England, as a historic first is integrated into long-standing religious traditions.
- 4) The passage describes the historic installation of Sarah Mullally as Archbishop of Canterbury, emphasising the symbolic importance of her role as the first woman to hold the position.

Question 8

There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide where (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: Children's instruments are often battered, but this one survived Wolfgang's peripatetic early years and custodianship in Nannerl's home, and later private ownership, before landing with the Mozarteum in 1896.

Paragraph: ____1____. By the time Wolfgang received the violin, he was already improvising and writing for keyboard instruments, which he picked up with phenomenal ease. ____2____. But he took a liking to his violin, and began to compose sonatas for it; these are some of his earliest pieces with multiple movements and a broader, more mature sense of form. ____3____. Quartets followed, along with a series of concertos that have become staples of the repertoire. The violin is more notable for its provenance than its sound, which is modest and a little nasal. But it is also remarkable for how well it has been preserved. ____4____.

- 1) Option 1
- 2) Option 2
- 3) Option 3
- 4) Option 4

Question 9

Five jumbled up sentences (labelled 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5), related to a topic, are given below. Four of them can be put together to form a coherent paragraph. Identify the odd sentence and key in the number of that sentence as your answer.

1. Jean Baudrillard's provocation that the Gulf War "did not take place" was not a denial that hundreds of thousands died in Iraq due to armed conflict but rather a structural claim about mediation.
2. The gap between event and representation had become the event itself, and war had been subsumed by its own image.
3. The war experienced by the world's publics, Baudrillard argued, was a television production that was narrated, sanitised, unmoored from the material suffering it depicted.
4. Baudrillard wrote about simulation replacing reality and AI has achieved something more radical where reality and simulation have become technically indistinguishable, and the platforms that mediate

both have no commercial incentive to help us tell them apart.

5. Ultimately, the armed conflict served as content.

[Integer Type — Key in the number of the odd sentence]

Directions for Questions 10 to 13: The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Chilli, ají, lup chew, mirich, felfel, bisabas, chilippurik - these are just a few names for a small fruit that delights people all over the world. Botanists may dispute the chili pepper's original birthplace, but its amazing journey across the world and adoption by many cultures marks the chili pepper as a global food. Archaeologists have estimated that humans began farming chili peppers between 5000 BCE and 3400 BCE, making them one of the oldest cultivated crops.

The Portuguese appear to be the first traders to have spread the chili pepper globally. It didn't take long for chili peppers to travel eastward ... but trade was only one agent of the chili pepper's spread: Portuguese intervention in Africa also played a large part. The Portuguese enslaved Africans from diverse locations to populate their plantations in the New World and separated family members - a strategy intended to reduce chance of rebellion since the slaves would lack a common language and culture. Portuguese slave traders traveled the continent and dispersed chili peppers along the way. Less is known about the chili pepper's travels across the Pacific. In 1529, the Treaty of Zaragoza defined Spanish and Portuguese jurisdiction in the Asia Pacific region: The Spanish received the Philippines, and Portugal received the Spice Islands, or Molucca. By 1540, the Portuguese were trading in Indonesia; soon after, chili peppers made their way to China.

However, it's unclear if the Portuguese were the first to bring the chili pepper to China. Indians and Arabs were actively trading with the Chinese long before the Europeans arrived. Furthermore, Hunan and Szechuan provinces, with cuisines that make frequent use of chili peppers, were connected to the non-Chinese world by the Silk Road trade route rather than by coastal ports. Moreover, at the time, there were no direct overland routes from Chinese ports to those two provinces.

One theory suggests that Muslim merchants brought chili peppers from India through the Persian Gulf, on to Aleppo or Alexandria, and then north into Eastern Europe. Alternatively, the Turks could have brought chili peppers from Asia and then transported them through the Persian Gulf, Asia Minor and the Black Sea into Hungary. From Hungary, the chili pepper then moved to Germany. Another possibility has the Portuguese exporting chili peppers from Hormuz, one of their colonies, to Eastern Europe to compete with black pepper from India. A German botanist in 1542 gives a recipe that calls for "Calicut pepper" and "Indian pepper." In 1868 Europeans learned that chili peppers were not originally from India. Perhaps most surprising is now long it took for the chili pepper to arrive in North America. Despite being grown in Mexico for centuries, the chili did not appear until the slave trade was well underway.

The chili pepper's global presence owes much to its resilience and capacity to be spread even without human intervention. No matter how you prefer to take your chili pepper - whether in Indian curry, mixed with Thai fish sauce, Korean kimchi, Mexican salsa, Hunan kung pao or as a pepperoncino in Italian antipasti - the fruit makes every dish more lively.

Question 10

In the context of the passage, which one of the following conclusions CANNOT be reached?

- 1) The spread of chili peppers was shaped by trade and forced migration.
- 2) The Portuguese were certainly the first to introduce chili to China.
- 3) Chili peppers rank among the earliest crops cultivated by humans.
- 4) The chili pepper became integrated into many global cuisines.

Question 11

If a trader brought chilli to medieval Europe, all of the following are unlikely to occur, EXCEPT:

- 1) The trader would face competition from Indian black pepper merchants.
- 2) The trader would access inland China through established coastal routes.
- 3) The trader would find direct overland links to Hunan provinces.
- 4) The trader would discover Europeans knew its American origin.

Question 12

It can be inferred from the passage that all of the following enhanced the appeal or desirability of chilli, EXCEPT:

- 1) Its integration into diverse regional culinary traditions.
- 2) Its resilience across varied climates and geographies.
- 3) Its influence on established spice trade structures.
- 4) Its prolonged historical ambiguity about origin.

Question 13

In the context of the passage, the reader would be least justified in concluding that:

- 1) The slave trade contributed to the pepper's geographic diffusion.
- 2) European political treaties shaped some trade routes.
- 3) The chili's global journey is known with complete certainty.
- 4) Existing trade networks influenced culinary adoption patterns.

Question 14

The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

A piece of performance art that was blocked from representing South Africa at the upcoming Venice Biennale over its supposedly "highly divisive" tribute to a Palestinian poet will go on display at the world's largest art exhibition after all. South African artist Gabrielle Goliath's project, *Elegy*, will be shown for three months from 4 May as a video installation at the Chiesa di Sant'Antonin church in the Castello district, a venue in the vicinity of the main site that is not part of the Biennale. The South African pavilion, meanwhile, will remain empty as the country's government declined to nominate a replacement for the show that was abruptly cancelled in January. Goliath said showing her work in Venice was vital because its cancellation had set "a dangerous precedent", coming "only as a result of [South African] culture minister McKenzie taking exception to certain aspects of the work and my refusal to change that". Made as a ritual of mourning for women killed in acts of sexualised or racialised violence, *Elegy* was first conceived in 2015 to commemorate murdered South African student Ipeleng Christine Moholane. The performance itself is non-verbal: the screens show seven operatically trained female performers emerging from a black background and holding a single high note for as long as they can, before retreating and being replaced by another singer.

- 1) Despite being barred from the Venice Biennale over political concerns, Gabrielle Goliath's *Elegy* will still be exhibited nearby, highlighting tensions around artistic freedom and censorship.
- 2) The cancellation of Gabrielle Goliath's *Elegy* from South Africa's Biennale pavilion led to its independent display in Venice, drawing attention to disputes over political expression in art.
- 3) Gabrielle Goliath's *Elegy*, removed from official representation due to controversy, will be shown outside the Biennale, underscoring concerns about censorship and precedent in artistic spaces.
- 4) A controversial performance artwork by Gabrielle Goliath, originally excluded from the Venice Biennale, will now be exhibited independently, reflecting debates over political sensitivity and artistic autonomy.

Directions for Questions 15 to 18: The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Within the world of political science there is a well-established analysis of what activates authoritarianism. This analysis is both challenging in what it discloses and profoundly evocative in what it fails to see.

First—what it discloses. Throughout the world there is a small part of the human population (roughly 25%) that remains authoritarian. Authoritarians value community based on hierarchy, order, and sameness, and respect leaders who are "simple, punitive and violent." There is a larger subset of the population, roughly 50%, whose authoritarianism is episodic, not constitutive, evoked under conditions of extensive change and extreme fear.

Both forms are now on the rise throughout the world, and the verdict of one leading political scientist is grim. Karen Stenner argues that gains in civil rights, and increasing racial, cultural and religious diversity will inevitably produce authoritarianism. She goes so far as to conclude that the pace of social change must be curtailed and that democracy itself has to be limited in order to survive, and she asks us to forgo the "religion of democracy for the science of democracy." While this political science is clear in its diagnosis of what activates the resurgence of authoritarianism, its findings are also fundamentally flawed and intrinsically limited—and here is our hope, here is our task.

There are two significant defects in the current research on authoritarianism. The first is intrinsic to the ways in which our basic political values are measured. Authoritarianism is measured, not by political beliefs, but by childrearing values that are then correlated with specific political positions. The values posed in existing research are set in opposition to each other—obedience versus self-reliance, respect for elders versus independence, good manners versus curiosity. Do you notice anything missing? When I have asked this of audiences throughout the U.S. since 2016, the answers are consistent: kindness, cooperation, a commitment to justice and fairness, empathy, compassion, service to and with others. Not only are these key values left out, but what is set in opposition are values that actually sustain and evoke each other. The fundamental flaw is in the limited range of childrearing values offered for consideration—reducing the choice to community or emancipated individualism, obedience and belonging, or independence and creativity.

The second flaw is that the data is not broken down by race. In the work of Indigenous, African American, and Latinx communities, we find a very different view of social order—one where the real choice is not individualism or belonging, but of *forms* of belonging, and how to responsibly use individual gifts in service to a wider social good. Moreover, political scientists Sirin, Valentino, and Villalobos found that while white ingroup identification is associated with lower outgroup empathy, the opposite is true for minorities: higher ingroup identification among Black and Latinx people is associated with *greater* empathy for other

marginalized groups. As they conclude, ingroup identification can facilitate, rather than hinder, outgroup empathy—and that empathy has the potential to be fostered across every race and ethnicity.

Question 15

The author's primary purpose in highlighting the missing childrearing values in the political science research is to:

- 1) Argue that political scientists are using irrelevant parameters leading to contradictory conclusions.
- 2) Illustrate that the tools used to identify authoritarianism are inadequate undermining the conclusions drawn from them.
- 3) Suggest that childrearing values are a reliable measure of political belief and should be measured accurately.
- 4) Argue that political scientists are biased and incompetent to make predictions on authoritarianism.

Question 16

Karen Stenner's conclusion that "the pace of social change must be curtailed and democracy itself limited in order to survive" is treated by the author as:

- 1) A position that the author reluctantly accepts despite its unsupported assumptions.
- 2) A well-intentioned but overly cautious position that sacrifices democratic ideals for the sake of political stability.
- 3) A flawed conclusion drawn from a fundamentally flawed research framework.
- 4) A negligible position within the broader field of political science.

Question 17

The findings of Sirin, Valentino, and Villalobos most directly challenge which widely held assumption about authoritarianism research?

- 1) That child rearing parameters are a reliable proxy for political beliefs.
- 2) That the consequences of ingroup-outgroup identification are overestimated.
- 3) That strong ingroup identification produces hostility towards outgroups.
- 4) That democracy requires a degree of cultural homogeneity to remain stable.

Question 18

The author states that values like obedience and independence are "set in opposition" when they "actually sustain and evoke each other." This argument, if accepted, would most significantly imply that:

- 1) Children raised to be obedient will naturally develop independence later in life.
- 2) The binary structure of the measurement scales produces artificially polarized political profiles, misrepresenting the actual distribution of authoritarian tendencies in the population.
- 3) Authoritarian childrearing and democratic childrearing are not meaningfully different in their political outcomes.
- 4) Political scientists should abandon childrearing values as a measurement tool entirely and return to direct political surveys.

Directions for Questions 19 to 22: The passage below is accompanied by four questions. Based on the passage, choose the best answer for each question.

Alan Turing and Gordon Moore could never have predicted, let alone altered, the rise of social media, memes, Wikipedia, or cyberattacks. Decades after their invention, the architects of the atomic bomb could no more stop a nuclear war than Henry Ford could stop a car accident. Technology's unavoidable

challenge is that its makers quickly lose control over the path their inventions take once introduced to the world.

Technology exists in a complex, dynamic system where second-, third-, and nth-order consequences ripple out unpredictably. What on paper looks flawless can behave differently out in the wild, especially when copied and further adapted downstream. What people actually do with your invention, however well intentioned, can never be guaranteed. Thomas Edison invented the phonograph so people could record their thoughts for posterity and to help the blind. He was horrified when most people just wanted to play music. Alfred Nobel intended his explosives to be used only in mining and railway construction. Gutenberg just wanted to make money printing Bibles, yet his press catalyzed the Scientific Revolution and became the greatest threat to the Catholic Church since its establishment.

Understanding technology is, in part, about trying to understand its unintended consequences — to predict not just positive spillovers but "revenge effects." Any technology is capable of going wrong, often in ways that directly contradict its original purpose. Think of how prescription opioids have created dependence, how the overuse of antibiotics renders them less effective, or how the proliferation of satellites and debris known as "space junk" imperils the very spaceflight it was meant to advance.

As technology proliferates, more people can use it, adapt it, and shape it however they like, in chains of causality beyond any individual's comprehension. As the power of our tools grows exponentially and access to them rapidly increases, so do the potential harms — an unfolding labyrinth of consequences that no one can fully predict or forestall. Within decades, work that seems irrelevant to the wider world produces existential questions for humanity. How do we guarantee that this new wave of technologies does more good than harm?

Technology's problem here is a containment problem. Containment is the overarching ability to control, limit, and, if need be, close down technologies at any stage of their development or deployment. It means, in some circumstances, the ability to stop a technology from proliferating in the first place, checking the ripple of unintended consequences. The more powerful a technology, the more ingrained it is in every facet of life and society — and so the need for containment grows more acute over time.

Does any of this get technologists off the hook? Not at all. We might not be able to control the final endpoints of our work, but that is no reason to abdicate responsibility. Decisions made at the source can still shape outcomes. Just because consequences are difficult to predict doesn't mean we shouldn't try.

Question 19

Which of the following best conveys the main point of the passage?

- 1) Technology's unintended consequences are inevitable, and technologists must work toward eliminating them at the source.
- 2) As technology grows more powerful, the responsibility for its consequences shifts from its creators to society at large.
- 3) While the consequences of technology cannot be fully predicted, technologists are not absolved of the responsibility to try to shape outcomes.
- 4) The only way to guarantee that technology does more good than harm is through effective containment at every stage of development.

Question 20

The author mentions Edison, Nobel, and Gutenberg primarily to illustrate that:

- 1) Inventors, regardless of their intentions, cannot be held responsible for the uses others make of their creations.
- 2) Well-intentioned inventors have repeatedly caused harm that could have been avoided with greater foresight.
- 3) The actual use and impact of an invention routinely diverges from the inventor's original intent.
- 4) The unintended consequences of past inventions have, on balance, been more transformative than their intended ones.

Question 21

The author would most likely agree with all of the following EXCEPT:

- 1) The wider the adoption of a technology, the greater the range of ways in which it can produce unintended harm.
- 2) The difficulty of predicting consequences relieves technologists of meaningful accountability for their inventions' effects.
- 3) A technology that becomes central to daily life presents a more acute containment challenge than one with limited reach.
- 4) The gap between an invention's intended purpose and its actual use is not unique to any particular era or field.

Question 22

Which of the following is the most accurate description of what the author means by "containment"?

- 1) The ability to anticipate and prevent unintended consequences before a technology is released to the public.
- 2) A corrective mechanism that societies deploy after a technology's harmful effects have become widely apparent.
- 3) The shared obligation of technologists and governments to ensure that powerful tools are not misused.
- 4) A proactive framework for managing a technology's reach and impact across its entire lifecycle.

Question 23

The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

When energy routes become battlefields, the global economy does not simply slow ~ it reorders itself. The current disruption centred on the Strait of Hormuz reveals less about the volatility of war and more about the enduring structure of power in the energy market. At first glance, the pattern appears familiar: producers gain, consumers lose. Yet this moment departs from past oil shocks in one critical respect ~ the benefits are not accruing to those at the epicentre of production, but to those positioned just outside it. Countries like Russia, already under sanctions pressure, find themselves unexpectedly advantaged. As supply chains strain and political priorities shift, discounted crude becomes strategically attractive. In effect, geopolitical isolation is being partially offset by economic necessity. This inversion carries consequences that extend beyond short-term price movements. For years, Western policy – particularly following the Ukraine war ~ has aimed to constrain Moscow's energy revenues. Yet the present crisis demonstrates how quickly such frameworks can unravel when global supply is threatened. What sanctions attempted to restrict, market conditions are now quietly restoring. The situation is no less paradoxical for the United States.

- 1) Disruptions in global energy routes are reshaping power dynamics, as countries outside conflict zones gain strategic advantage, weakening the intended impact of sanctions on producers like Russia.
- 2) The Strait of Hormuz crisis shows that energy conflicts now benefit peripheral producers rather than central ones, thereby undermining established assumptions about winners and losers in oil shocks.
- 3) Current energy disruptions highlight how geopolitical crises can reverse expected outcomes, enabling sanctioned producers like Russia to regain influence despite efforts to limit their revenues.
- 4) The ongoing energy crisis reveals a structural shift in global markets, where supply disruptions and strategic positioning allow isolated producers to benefit, challenging Western policy objectives.

Question 24

Five jumbled up sentences (labelled 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5), related to a topic, are given below. Four of them can be put together to form a coherent paragraph. Identify the odd sentence and key in the number of that sentence as your answer.

1. Something I've been working on over these past months and years is being able to sit with doubt.
2. At the beginning of the year, I always like to do a couple of episodes on things that I am working on in my own life.
3. At a certain point, I found that this kind of inquiry, as fulfilling as it was, did not really delve deep enough into my existential experience, as it were.
4. Because the first person we believe is ourselves: the stories we tell, the things we think we already know.
5. And not just doubt — being able to sit in the wonder of uncertainty.

[Integer Type — Key in the number of the odd sentence]